

01

REASON, REVELATION AND FAITH

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

It does not establish any theological claim.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

It does not establish any theological claim.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□ Fact: Religion News Service reported on 26 May 2026 that a consortium involving Brigham Young, Baylor, Notre Dame and Yeshiva researchers tested fourteen AI models for multi-faith bias and presented findings at an AI ethics summit in Athens. □□ Inference: The episode gives a contemporary use for the 2020 science–technology PYQ: technical systems can classify and reproduce religious perspectives, but questions of moral authority, fairness and human dignity remain philosophical and normative.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

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02

REASON, REVELATION AND FAITH: CORE DISTINCTIONS

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Role (2024 PYQ): reason (a) constructs natural theology (proofs for God), (b) tests coherence of doctrines, (c) interprets scripture, (d) defends faith (apologetics). □ Rationalism: religious beliefs must meet the bar of reason/evidence (Clifford: "it is wrong always... to believe anything upon insufficient evidence"). □ Limits: proofs are inconclusive (see Proofs note); the transcendent may exceed reason → space for revelation & faith. □□ Rational vs irrational aspects of faith (2023): faith has a rational side (grounds, coherence, cumulative evidence) and a supra-/non-rational side (trust, commitment, the leap beyond proof). □□.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Core argument/criticism: Each faculty corrects the excess of the others: reason restrains arbitrariness, revelation resists reductionism, and faith converts alleged disclosure into lived commitment.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

[Aquinas] "How does Aquinas' faith-as-'intellectual assent' reconcile reason & faith?" (2025) → §3. [Reason] "Role of reason in religion." (2024) → §1. [Revelation] "Distinguish natural & revealed theology (propositional view)." (2025) → §2. [Justification] "Epistemic justifications of revelation-claims." (2024) → §2. [Faith-revelation] "Is faith indispensable for revelation?" (2022) → §3. [Science] "Significance of religion vis-à-vis present scientific and technological development." (2020, 10m) → §9.6 — Barbour's four models, not a Galileo narrative. [Faith/belief] "Basic tenets of faith; distinguish faith and belief." (2020, 15m) → §9.7 — enumerate the seven tenets, then the five axes. [Justification] "Can religious beliefs be justified?" (2023, 10m) → §9.9 — evidentialism vs Reformed epistemology; add the svataḥ/parataḥ-prāmānya mapping. [Reason regulative] "Can reason be a regulative force in forming religious beliefs?" (2021, 20m) → §1 + §9.1 + §9.9 — regulative ≠ constitutive; reason can veto and discipline without generating. [Rational/irrational] "Rational and irrational aspects of faith." (2023, 15m) → §9.5 — insist on supra-rational as a third category. [Miracles] "Can testimony establish a miracle?" → §9.8.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Final verdict: Aquinas offers the most balanced model when reason establishes preambles and faith assents to mysteries that exceed but do not contradict reason.

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Final verdict: Aquinas offers the most balanced model when reason establishes preambles and faith assents to mysteries that exceed but do not contradict reason.

ANSWER LINE: Revelation is an alleged divine self-disclosure that supplies truth or presence unavailable to unaided reason.